

Google Project Genie can now turn real locations into interactive AI worlds



Google has updated Project Genie, its AI world-generation tool, to pull in imagery from Google Street View. Users can select US locations via a Maps pin, choose a visual style like Ocean World, add a custom character, and explore an AI-generated interactive world built around that location. tinyurl.com/gg762yhb

Anthropic releases Claude Design to help create visuals



OpenAI has launched GPT-5.5 Instant as the new default ChatGPT model, claiming 52.5 percent fewer hallucinations than GPT-5.3 Instant on high-stakes prompts and over 37 percent fewer incorrect answers. It offers better image analysis, shorter responses, and personalisation using past chats and connected services like Gmail. It is available to all ChatGPT users, with API access as chat-latest. tinyurl.com/h8di923

The Monet AI experiment

It exposed how we think about creativity and authenticity

—By **Vyom Ramani**

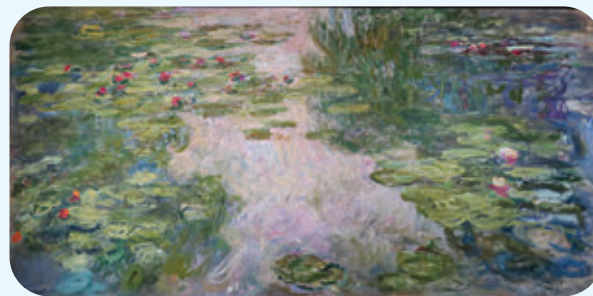
Looking at what's happening on X sometimes shows you a side of how we as humans think and react. Someone who had posted a Claude Monet styled painting that they said was AI generated and asked what made it inferior to a real Monet. The answer to that question is very elementary if you ask me, had Monet never thought of making such paintings, generating impressionist art of that caliber wouldn't be possible for even the best of the LLMs. AI-art is many things but original isn't one of them, yet.

The internet, for its part, did what it does and absolutely tore it apart. "No cohesion of elements." "Looks like high school art." "It's garbage." The brushwork was wrong, the colours felt off, the composition lacked depth. People were so confident and articulate that you would think these are art majors. There was a small catch though that the painting wasn't actually AI generated but an actual Claude Monet painting – namely the "Water Lilies."

The second someone tells us something is AI-generated, we immediately

start looking for flaws. And the thing about looking for flaws is you find them easily. Every single time without fail.

This is exactly what confirmation bias is. We had an interpretation ready and all we do is search for arguments that supported that interpretation. Call the painting AI and the brush strokes start



looking mechanical and lifeless. Call it human and the brush strokes are now expressive and intentional.

Now this experiment did not at all say that an AI is at the level of Monet. That would be a pretty silly conclusion to arrive at. Monet's work exists because Monet existed – because he stood in his garden at specific hours of specific days, chasing light that wouldn't hold still, half-blind toward the end of his life, still painting. Everything else that we gen-

erate today representing any impressionist work using any model is merely a sophisticated echo. You cannot separate the output from the source material.

The people here weren't engaging with the painting, instead it was the label. That is more uncomfortable to think about because now when we

look at art, our first instinct isn't to appreciate it but ask if it is actually real.

Experiencing art has always been about its narrative. Who made it, why did they make it, under what conditions and at what cost are all

questions that matter. A Monet carries the weight of a biography. An AI image carries the weight of a prompt.

What I keep coming back to is this – if the label shapes the experience this completely, then we need to be more honest about what we're evaluating when we critique AI art. Are we engaging with the image, or are we reacting to our feelings about the technology behind it? Most of the time, I suspect it's the latter. tinyurl.com/dd7hxza